

India's first solar PV testing lab completes 1GW of testing

India's first mobile solar photovoltaic (PV) testing lab, designed and developed by Mahindra Susten, recently crossed a milestone of 1GW of plant testing. Mahindra Susten is part of the US\$ 20.7 billion Mahindra Group, and one of the largest renewable energy companies in India with a growing global presence.

Magenta Power installs India's first EV billing meter in association with MSEDCL

Magenta Power has announced India's first electric vehicle (EV) billing meter in association with Maharashtra State Electricity Distribution Co Ltd (MSEDCL). The EV billing meter is launched in sync with the government's plans to support the adoption of EVs.

Amara Raja to set up lithium-ion plant in Andhra Pradesh

Amara Raja Batteries will build a lithium-ion assembly plant in Andhra Pradesh, as it seeks to grab a slice of the EV power packs market, which is set to grow to US\$ 300 billion by 2030. The project is at an incubation stage, exploring market demand and going through the product development cycle. The company is building solutions for early stage electrification of vehicles, and will also work with OEMs at the same time.

JSW plans to produce EVs at GM's Pune plant

JSW Group plans to enter the automobile manufacturing segment by making EVs at General Motors' (GM's) car plant in Pune.

second industrial park in India, in Greater Noida. With this development, the company has strengthened its commitment towards the central government's Make in India initiative to boost local manufacturing.

Under the terms of the agreement, Haier will invest ₹ 30.69 billion in two phases, for setting up its industrial park in the state over the next four years. With this development, the company is expected to create almost 4000 direct jobs along with more than 10,000 indirect jobs. The expansion will also serve as an opportunity for

GM plans to wind up its operations in India by selling its plant to JSW. JSW is interested in this unit in Pune for the sole purpose of working on its JSW cars, an all-new range of EVs.

NASSCOM launches Accelerate 10X programme for AI startups

National Association of Software and Services Companies (NASSCOM) has announced that it will start mentoring programmes on artificial intelligence (AI), machine learning (ML) and blockchain technologies through its Accelerate 10X programme. Accelerate 10X will take up mentorship for 10,000 startups in India in association with Techstars, Google, Facebook, IBM, Amazon Web Services (AWS) and Microsoft.

Foxconn's India head says cellphone imports have declined by half in 2017-18

Josh Foulger, country head and managing director, Foxconn International Holding, India, has informed that India's cellphone imports in FY2017-18 declined to half that of the previous year's. Imports of completely built-in units also witnessed a fall from 78 to 18 per cent. Foulger cited the growing number of locally-produced devices as the reason behind the drop in imports.

LTI and PTC Unveil IoT Center of Excellence

Larsen & Toubro Infotech (LTI) in alliance with US-based PTC has unveiled a state-of-the-art center of excellence (CoE) in Bengaluru, focused on Internet of Things (IoT)-based innovations. The CoE will focus specifically on Industry 4.0 solutions in manufacturing, and oil and gas sectors.

local vendors and original equipment manufacturers (OEMs).

AMETEK India opens technology solutions centre in Bengaluru

AMETEK Instruments India has established a technology solutions centre at its headquarters in Whitefield, Bengaluru to support the growth of its electronics instrument and electromechanical products businesses in India.

The company has invested US\$ 5.5 million in establishing Technology

Solutions Centre, and expects it to be a great resource for its customers in designing new products, selecting the right equipment to meet their application needs, servicing and calibrating devices, and providing hands-on demonstrations and trainings.

Boeing sets up electronics, avionics facility in India

Global aerospace major Boeing is setting up an electronics manufacturing and avionics assembly facility in Bengaluru with an investment of ₹ 11.52 billion. Thirty six acres have been allotted for Boeing India to set up the facility in the state-run Aerospace Park at Devanahalli, near the airport in north Bengaluru.

Boeing India president, Pratyush Kumar met state chief minister H.D. Kumaraswamy at the state secretariat to discuss the project. As part of Boeing's Engineering and Technology Centre in India, the facility will create about 2600 direct jobs when set up and commissioned.

Competition in LED market intensifies after Syska slashes prices

The domestic LED lighting industry is going through a tough time after Syska Group cut its prices by nearly 10 to 15 per cent. The move came as a shock to players like Crompton Greaves Consumer Electricals and Havells India, as rising commodity prices are hurting the industry.

In an analysts' meet held recently, representatives from Crompton Greaves Consumer Electricals were a bit cautious about short-term growth in the lighting business as LED price cuts will impact the margins of the company in the coming quarter. Of the overall business for Crompton Greaves Consumer Electricals, about 30 per cent comes from lighting and of that slice, LEDs account for 30 per cent, which is around nine per cent of the overall business.

Credit Suisse has cut its FY19 and FY21 earnings per share estimates by three to four per cent to factor in the margin pressure in the lighting business. Another player, Havells is also under pressure and its annual growth is down by about three per cent.